

June

6



1523

Rebel leader becomes king

Swedish nobleman Gustav Vasa, who had led rebel forces in the Swedish War of Liberation, was elected king of Sweden. Swedes celebrate this day as their National Day.

Born this day

1875 Thomas Mann, German writer. Known for novels such as *Doctor Faustus*, he received the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1929.

1956 Björn Borg, Swedish tennis player. He was the first male player to win five consecutive Wimbledon titles.

Allies to the rescue

In an operation code-named “Operation Overlord”, 150,000 Allied soldiers stormed the beaches of Normandy, France, to liberate the country from German occupation during World War II. This day is known as D-Day.



1933

Drive-in cinema

US entrepreneur Richard Hollingshead, Jr opened the world's first drive-in cinema in New Jersey, USA. He used a 1928 Kodak projector and a white screen hung between two trees so that people could enjoy watching films in their cars.

Also on this day

1896 Norwegians George Harbo and Frank Samuelson became the first people to row across the Atlantic Ocean, covering 5,262 km (3,270 miles) in 55 days.

1912 A volcanic eruption in the Katmai National Park and Preserve in Alaska, USA, led to the formation of the Novarupta volcano. It was the largest eruption of the 20th century.

2017 Island iguanas

A new species of iguana called *Brachylophus gau*, found only on Gau island in the Fijian archipelago, was discovered by researchers.